

Creating Opportunities through Co-op, Grade 11

Open

DCO30

This course consists of a learning experience connected to a community and a cooperative education curriculum focused on developing skills, knowledge, and habits of mind that will support students in their learning, including their education and career/life planning, at school and beyond, today and in the future. Within the context of their experience connected to a community, students will apply skills, knowledge, and habits of mind that will protect and promote their health, safety, and well-being and that will strengthen their inquiry, decision-making, and leadership skills. Students will create and implement a learning plan that meets their particular interests and needs, reflect on their learning, and make connections between their experience in the community and other aspects of their lives.

Prerequisite: None

A. PREPARING FOR THE EXPERIENCE: HEALTH AND SAFETY, WELL-BEING, AND INITIAL REQUIREMENTS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

- A1. Health, Safety, and Well-Being:** demonstrate an understanding of legislation, practices, and behaviours related to health, safety, and well-being in connection with the cooperative education experience
- A2. Preparing and Planning for the Experience:** demonstrate an understanding of requirements and various considerations related to the cooperative education experience, in preparation for the experience

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Health, Safety, and Well-Being

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

- A1.1** identify legislation, regulations, and policies related to health and safety, and explain how they apply to the cooperative education experience (e.g., *the Occupational Health and Safety Act [OHSA]* as it applies to (1) a worker's right to: know about any hazards to which they may be exposed, participate in the process of identifying and resolving health and safety concerns, and refuse work they believe is dangerous, and (2) the employer's responsibility to provide site- and equipment-specific Mandatory Worker Awareness Training; *the Workplace Safety and Insurance Act [WSIA]*; *the Work Education Agreement [WEA]* and the process of responding to workplace-related accidents and illnesses, including reporting injuries and providing support for recovery; *the Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System [WHMIS]* and regulations requiring employers to: label or identify controlled products, obtain material safety data sheets for controlled products, and educate workers; company policies on health screening, criminal record checks, workplace violence, workplace harassment, emergency procedures, and acceptable use of technology)

Teacher prompts: "Workers that are new to their job, including young workers, are three times more likely to be injured in the first month than at any other time. In addition to providing the Mandatory Worker Awareness Training, what

are the responsibilities of employers to ensure that the workplace supports the safety of workers?" "The definition of 'worker' under the Occupational Health and Safety Act (OHSA) includes unpaid secondary school students who are participating in a work experience authorized by their school board. What are these students' roles and responsibilities, as workers, in helping to maintain a safe work environment? How will you determine your specific responsibilities with respect to safety?" "Is it advisable for you to have student accident insurance for your co-op experience? Why or why not?"

- A1.2** identify legislation, regulations, and policies, as well as various strategies and skills, that support well-being (including emotional safety) and the protection of human rights, and explain how they apply to the cooperative education experience (e.g., **legislation, regulations, policies:** *Ontario's Human Rights Code* prohibits discrimination and harassment based on seventeen protected grounds, including race, creed, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, and gender expression; *the Occupational Health and Safety Act [OHSA]* sets out the rights and duties of all parties in the workplace to protect workers from health and safety hazards on the job; *the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FIPPA)* protects confidentiality and the right to privacy; *the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA)* sets accessibility standards in order to achieve accessibility for people with disabilities;

the Employment Standards Act (ESA) requires that working conditions meet acceptable standards; strategies, skills: practices consistent with the acceptable use of technology; communication skills and strategies, including the appropriate way to respond to and report situations that make one feel uncomfortable or that are inappropriate; conflict resolution strategies; consulting with a trusted adult, such as a teacher, guidance counsellor, parent, or Elder – or in the case of adult students, a partner; using time management skills; setting priorities; appreciating differences among individuals)

Teacher prompts: “How might you respond when you witness a co-worker being bullied or harassed?” “During previous co-op or employment experiences, what did you observe that demonstrated respect for human rights within the organization?” “How we cope with stress can have a considerable effect on our mental health and can affect our safety and well-being in the workplace. What can you do to maintain a healthy school/life/work balance?” “How will you know which well-being and/or human rights issues you can address on your own, and which ones you need to refer to others?” “Who will you speak with to request religious accommodations during your cooperative education experience?” “In your cooperative education experience, you may feel that you are not receiving enough direction or the support you need to successfully complete your tasks. If you don’t get the support you need, you may find that your self-confidence and self-esteem suffer. You may start to blame yourself, or you may feel undervalued. In either case, you may need emotional support, and advice to help you deal with your feelings and the situation. What can you do to help yourself? Who can you turn to for help?” “Both emotional and physical safety are integral to a successful cooperative education experience. What are some characteristics of emotional safety? What are the conditions that might help you feel emotionally safe? What can you do to support your own emotional safety? What legislation protects emotional safety?”

- A1.3** identify potential hazards and potentially hazardous situations that could arise in connection with the cooperative education experience, and describe the behaviours and practices that would help prevent and that assist in responding to such situations (e.g., *the use of required clothing and personal protective equipment [PPE] such as hardhats, safety glasses, ear protection, CSA-approved steel-toed boots for workers in manufacturing facilities; prompt attention to or reporting of faulty equipment, such as missing safety guards on an industrial mixer; clear procedures*

for incident/accident reporting; behaviours that assist in maintaining the safety of all workers at the workplace, such as immediately cleaning up spills to protect workers from potential slips and falls; online security and warnings against criminal or inappropriate use of the Internet, including cyberbullying)

Teacher prompts: “How can you recognize potential hazards at the site of, or related to, your cooperative education experience? What questions might you ask yourself and others when assessing a hazard and/or determining what to do to prevent incidents and keep safe?” “Resources and services for workers may differ, depending on the nature of the experience and the kinds of learning opportunities involved. What safety-related resources and services should be provided at your cooperative education placement?” “How do effective communication skills support safety?” “What are some actions you can take to promote your own and/or others’ safety during your cooperative education experience? What would you do if you felt it was necessary to advocate on your own and others’ behalf with respect to safety concerns?” “WHMIS is a regulation that applies to all workplaces where hazardous materials are stored or used. How are hazardous materials identified, and how can you determine what is needed to protect yourself when working with hazardous materials?”

A2. Preparing and Planning for the Experience

Before the cooperative education experience, students will:

- A2.1** explore a variety of topics that relate to the cooperative education experience and the particular sector or area of focus of the experience (e.g., *local and global economic issues; emerging economies; labour market trends in the overall economy and in the particular sector or area of focus of the cooperative education experience; workplace/online culture; in the case of international cooperative education experiences: cultural values, beliefs, and local laws; corporate social responsibility initiatives; the appropriate use of social media in the workplace; organizational structures in the non-profit sector; the influence of Indigenous teaching practices and protocols in the education sector; globalization in the transportation sector; the role of unions in the construction sector; entrepreneurial opportunities in the energy sector; the impact of technology in the mining sector; postsecondary programs in the area of logistics; recruitment and employment strategies that support*

diversity and inclusion; the potential wage and benefit structure associated with various career pathways within the sector; types of employment, such as full-time employment, self-employment, and contract, seasonal, and part-time work) and explain how what they learned might contribute to success in their cooperative education experience and to their education and career/life planning

Teacher prompts: “What are some key questions to consider when preparing for an employment interview in the information, communication, and technology sector?” “What role might social media play in your job search? How is your ‘digital footprint’ relevant to your job search? What effect might your online history have on an employer’s opinion of you?” “What are some of the factors that influence the local and/or global economy, and how might these factors affect future employment opportunities?” “What programs are available to support your specific interests for postsecondary learning, and how can you access these programs?” “Reviewing career development information sites, visiting the organization for a face-to-face meeting, and researching labour market information are some ways of exploring education and career opportunities. What are the best strategies for learning about the sector/area of focus of your co-op experience?” “What are the professional or regulatory associations and various communities (local, global, virtual) in the field of work that interests you?”

A2.2 describe their personal skills, interests, and strengths (e.g., *skills: technical, collaboration, numeracy, innovation, communication, time-management skills; knowledge of other languages; interests: working with children, outdoor experiences, sports, music, cooking, working with tools, travelling, social media, helping others, animal welfare; strengths: the ability to motivate and inspire others, resilience, perseverance, empathy, sense of humour, honesty, trustworthiness, flexibility*) and explain how these might contribute to success in their cooperative education experience

Teacher prompts: “One of the stages of the education and career/life planning process involves reflecting on the question, ‘Who am I?’. What are the characteristics that describe who you are? Consider your interests, values, skills, and strengths, including habits of mind that you feel are strengths.” “What are some of the factors that have shaped who you are and who you may become over time?” “How can you use information from your Individual Pathways Plan (IPP) and other tools to understand and develop your skills, interests, and strengths?”

“Employers consistently report that effective communication skills are important for every worker. What communication skills are relevant to your cooperative education experience in hairstyling?” “Some people have passionate interests – for example, in cooking, jewellery-making, or video games or about social issues such as the environment, poverty, or LGBTQ issues – that can influence their decisions about postsecondary pathways. Based on your interests, what issues are important to you? How might your interests relate to your cooperative education experience?” “How would you describe your interview skills and strengths?” “Your virtual cooperative education experience will involve some web design. What are some of the skills you have developed in your Visual Arts courses that will give you a head start in learning about web design?” “You are interested in a co-op experience in the manufacturing sector, but you do not have any previous work experience in this area. During an interview with a prospective placement supervisor, how will you describe the skills and knowledge you have developed in your Manufacturing Technology course? How will you explain why that learning will be useful in the placement?”

A2.3 identify the initial steps and requirements related to the cooperative education experience and demonstrate what they are doing to meet these requirements (e.g., *completing the application/interview process; determining details of the experience, such as hours of work, schedule, and breaks; developing and implementing a transportation plan for getting to their placement; getting the placement supervisor’s contact information; completing the Work Education Agreement; finding out about the equipment to be used, and about any certification or training requirements; reviewing attendance policies and codes of conduct; developing a business plan and/or project proposal; developing the Student’s Cooperative Education Learning Plan; in the case of an international cooperative education experience: completing appropriate health screening; asking questions to deepen their understanding of any school or board requirements for students taking a cooperative education course; anticipating challenges that might arise in connection with the experience and seeking clarification by asking questions*)

Teacher prompts: “The co-op experience directly involves the teacher, the placement supervisor, and you. However, others may also be affected by it. How might your participating in co-op affect your family members, friends, or employers? What do you need to consider

before you start your co-op experience?" "What do you think some of the initial requirements for your co-op experience will be? What will you need to arrange for before the experience starts? What will you need to bring with you to the placement? How will you confirm what is actually required?" "In order to ensure safety and to maximize learning, the employer and student are often required to read or complete, understand, and (where appropriate), sign certain agreements and other documents. How can you ensure that you understand the content of the documents? Why are some documents signed and others not? How do you determine which documents need to be signed and how long you need to keep the documents? What could be the consequences of breaching these signed agreements/documents?"

B. EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING AND TRANSFER OF SKILLS AND KNOWLEDGE

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Student's Cooperative Education Learning Plan:** develop, implement, and reflect on a learning plan, including learning related to health, safety, and well-being, to maximize success in the cooperative education experience
- B2. Skills for the Future:** demonstrate the skills and knowledge developed or refined through the cooperative education experience, including skills and knowledge related to health, safety, and well-being, and explain how they might use what they have learned in other aspects of their lives, now and in the future

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Student's Cooperative Education Learning Plan

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** develop their learning plan by determining short- and medium-term learning goals for the cooperative education experience (e.g., *short-term goal: to practise communicating information about their knowledge, skills, and interests for an interview to secure a cooperative education placement; medium-term goal: to use effective time-management strategies to ensure that they achieve all course expectations; to learn more about being respectful of people's diversity, in terms of ethnocultural and/or socio-economic background, language, gender identity, and other areas of diversity; to learn about the ways in which social media can affect relationships; to develop greater understanding of the mental health concerns that many young people experience and to learn about strategies that can be used to address them*) and longer-term education and career/life goals (e.g., *to use job search strategies to obtain a summer job; to save money for postsecondary education, training, or community living; to locate an employer who will sponsor them in a continued apprenticeship in carpentry; to obtain the advanced health and safety certification required to work in a child care setting; to volunteer at an organization that supports students in addressing mental health concerns; to*

develop and maintain a positive online presence, with a view to building an e-portfolio), and identify strategies to achieve these goals

Teacher prompts: "How would you describe a successful cooperative education experience? What do you need to learn by the end of the experience? What are some short- and/or medium-term learning goals that will help you succeed?" "How can you use what you have learned about yourself to help you set and achieve your goals?" "Think about the people who might help you to meet your goal(s). In what ways could they support you? What is the appropriate way to ask for their help?" "What resources are available that can help you learn about some of your career/life goals, such as saving and investing for your education?"

- B1.2** actively and safely participate in the cooperative education experience as they implement their learning plan (e.g., *show initiative – for instance, by offering to explore technological options that could enhance the organization's customer surveys; ask questions to clarify their understanding of tasks and of how to perform them safely; observe and demonstrate appropriate practices and procedures for safety and well-being and for environmental protection; where appropriate, be prepared with the right tools, equipment, and/or materials; work collaboratively*

as part of a team; offer suggestions about using social media and other electronic means of communication, accommodating a variety of languages and formats where possible)

Teacher prompts: “Actively and intentionally observing others during your experience – seeing what they do and how they behave – can be a powerful learning strategy. How can you use observation to identify learning opportunities that align with your goals and to help increase your participation in your cooperative education experience?” “Actively participating in a cooperative education experience may be difficult at times. Some ways to support active participation include: taking time to understand the work culture; building relationships with other workers, clients, partners, and supervisors in a professional, productive manner that will help the organization or company achieve its goals; being receptive to new opportunities that may present themselves; and taking appropriate, calculated risks while always maintaining safety and well-being. What are some scenarios in which you can imagine applying these strategies? What are some other ways in which you can actively and safely participate in your co-op experience?” “One of your goals is to help increase the number of visits to the company’s website. How might you access and engage with mentors to support the development of your ideas?” “How might selecting and applying appropriate tools, language skills, and strategies assist you in communicating and collaborating effectively in your cooperative education experience?” “How will you know which tasks can only be done by a certified or qualified professional, which tasks you can perform independently, and which ones require supervision or support?”

- B1.3** analyse and reflect on their learning plan, and revise it over time as appropriate

Teacher prompts: “During the cooperative education experience, regularly reviewing your goals and documenting and reflecting on your learning will help you see the progress you are making. Ask yourself what you have learned as you proceed through the experience, including what you have learned about yourself. How will you be able to tell that you’ve made progress in meeting your goals? How will you measure your progress? What adjustments do you need to make to help you achieve your goals?” “How might some of the goals you set be modified to help you succeed at school, at work, or in other areas of your life?” “You have achieved many of your short-term goals. How has your experience

so far influenced your thinking about your long-term goals?” “How can the feedback you receive from your placement supervisor and your teacher assist you in revising your learning plan?”

B2. Skills for the Future

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** identify and describe the skills and knowledge they have developed through their cooperative education experience (e.g., *critical thinking, problem-solving, creative and entrepreneurial thinking, time-management, technical, negotiation, communication, and interpersonal skills; knowledge specific to the organization or sector; knowledge related to health, safety, and well-being, roles and responsibilities of workers, planning for their post-secondary endeavours; understanding of personal interests, strengths, and habits of mind*)

Teacher prompts: “Describe how you developed technical and safety skills throughout your co-op experience.” “How did you use negotiation skills to help balance the demands of the co-op experience, the rest of your courses, and home life? Why did you think it would be appropriate to negotiate with your placement supervisor for more flexible hours? In retrospect, would you change your approach? Might you try to negotiate a different schedule with your teacher instead?” “Understanding and adhering to policies pertaining to confidentiality, privacy, and acceptable use of technology are important to many different industry sectors and are part of responsible digital citizenship. Explain why these policies are important, how they can protect people, why they were created, and how they may have evolved over time.” “During your co-op experience, you applied your knowledge of WHMIS when you handled hazardous materials. When you reflect on it, do you think this practice has become a habit of mind, something that is now second nature to you? Can you identify when and how this shift came about?”

- B2.2** demonstrate how they are using skills and knowledge related to education and career/life planning in connection with their cooperative education experience (e.g., *reflecting on the education and career/life planning inquiry questions – Who am I? What are my opportunities? Who do I want to become? What is my plan for achieving my goals? – as they progress through the experience, and incorporating their insights in their Individual Pathways Plan*)

Teacher prompts: “You have spent some time identifying and understanding factors and experiences that have shaped who you are. Which of these factors or experiences are relevant to your co-op experience?” “How has participating in co-op expanded your awareness of postsecondary opportunities?” “Your co-op experience might have provided some insights into the demands and rewards of careers in that sector. Reflect on the fit between the realities of the work and who you want to become.” “Reflect on the goals you set in your Individual Pathways Plan and your Student’s Cooperative Education Learning Plan. Based on what you’ve learned in your co-op experience, what kinds of financial and emotional support do you think you will need to achieve your goals? What other types of support might you need?” “Career-related decision making is often fluid and unpredictable, and rarely linear. How do you think your co-op experience to date might influence how you navigate the path through school to your initial postsecondary destination and beyond?”

B2.3 describe how they might use the skills and knowledge developed through their cooperative education experience in other aspects of their lives, now and in the future (*e.g., in their education, training, workplace, or community living experiences; in their volunteer activities and hobbies; in their lives at home or within various communities, including online communities*)

Teacher prompts: “Reflect on the skills and knowledge that you have developed through the cooperative education experience and document this learning in your Individualized Pathways Plan (IPP). Explain how this knowledge and these skills might assist you in other aspects of your life.” “You worked on a team during your co-op experience and developed communication and time-management skills. How can you use these skills in your volunteer work at your local friendship centre?” “How will you use the skills and knowledge gained from your international co-op experience to bring greater awareness of other cultures to your peers, family, and community?” “You gained experience developing a business plan for your prototype. What are some financial questions you need to consider and what logistical supports might you need to further develop and market your product locally,

nationally, internationally, and/or online?” “Reflecting on your service learning* experience, what insights would you say that you have gained into the realities and complexities of the community? How did you learn from the community and how did community members learn from you? How has this experience changed your perspective on the particular issue or situation you were trying to address? How can your experience support the design, implementation, and evaluation of an initiative to address the issue?” “During your co-op experience, how do you think you were perceived by your co-workers? By clients/customers? What makes you think that? In what way might knowing how others perceive you help to inform your actions now and in the future?” “You explained that your experience taught you the value of perseverance. In what other aspects of your life might this habit of mind help you achieve your goals?” “You have achieved your goal of increasing your confidence in your customer-service abilities. How might you put this new sense of confidence to work in your other courses at school?” “What aspects of your co-op experience seem most likely to help you in dealing with situations that might arise at school or in the community in the future?”

* *Service learning* is an experiential learning opportunity with a focus on service in the community – specifically, on addressing a need within a community or group. Service learning is intended to benefit both the provider and the recipient of the service.

C. THE INQUIRY PROCESS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Exploration and Investigation:** explore and investigate a topic, issue, or process relevant to the cooperative education experience, formulating questions to guide research, gathering information, and making connections to the cooperative education experience
- C2. Analysis and Communication:** analyse the information gathered through the investigation and communicate results, making connections to the cooperative education experience and other current and future endeavours

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Exploration and Investigation

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** identify and explore a variety of topics, issues, and/or processes related to the cooperative education experience (*e.g., emerging trends in specific industry sectors; wages, benefits and potential employment opportunities; pathways to apprenticeship; the impact of social media on the workplace; new equipment available for improving workplace safety; the need for a new app related to the organization or sector; a recycling program for a construction project; innovative hair-colouring techniques; new soldering techniques; the relationship between merchandising and sales; conflict-resolution techniques and strategies; poverty, racism, sexism, mental health [as these issues relate to workplaces]; biodiversity, pollution, climate change, natural disasters [as these issues relate to particular sectors]; getting workers to adopt changes that make food-processing safer; legal processes for developing a patent; business plan models for starting your own business; design processes for developing a computer application; how marketing plans are drawn up*)

Teacher prompts: “What have you noticed in your co-op experience that interests you? What do you want to know more about?” “What issues or topics related to your co-op sector have been addressed in the media?” “In what ways has your co-op sector changed in recent years? What caused these changes? What future developments might be expected in view of these changes?” “What are some tasks you have performed during your co-op experience

that you might want to investigate?” “Before you started your co-op placement, you explored some topics related to the placement or the sector. Now that you have started your placement, how may your experience to date provoke further thinking and deeper exploration of one or more of these topics?”

- C1.2** develop questions to guide their research on a chosen topic, issue, or process (*e.g., factual questions: “What is the legislation on pay equity in Canada?”; causal questions: “How is the agricultural sector responding to a potential future labour shortage?”; comparative questions: “What are some current retail trends in Canada? Are they different from trends around the world?”*), making connections to their cooperative education experience

Teacher prompts: “You’ve brainstormed a list of questions on the topic of gender equity in the workplace to guide your research. When you review the list, do you notice any questions that overlap and that might be combined into one question? Are any of the questions only marginally related to your topic? If you remove them, do the remaining questions provide a focus for your investigation? What will be your next step?” “How could your factual question about truck and coach apprenticeship be adjusted to support deeper learning?” “Your chosen topic is the impact that unions have had on different aspects of work, such as health, safety, and well-being. How do your research questions support learning about different perspectives on this topic?” “How can you check for bias in your questions?”

C1.3 investigate the chosen topic, issue, or process by gathering and organizing information (e.g., *gathering information: through first-hand experience and/or research into primary and secondary sources to identify facts and issues, challenges and successes, what has been done before, and different perspectives on issues; organizing information: using graphic organizers, summaries, audio/digital records, tables, notes, infographics*) from a variety of sources (e.g., *observations, open-ended interviews, surveys and questionnaires, social media, advertisements; various print and electronic media, including books and journals, magazine articles, websites, textbooks*)

Teacher prompts: “What search terms/key words would you use to find answers to your research questions about pathways to apprenticeship?” “Are there sector or professional organizations or NGOs that could provide information to support your research?” “When researching gender equity in the workplace, why is it important to assess information gathered from various sources for accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values, bias, and voice?” “You’ve chosen to investigate the topic of patents. What steps would you take to obtain a patent for a process or product that you have developed? Why do you think these steps are important?” “Your investigation relates to building a computer. Where will you look for the information you need about parts? How will you source the parts? Would cost be a factor in choosing the components?” “How would a concept map assist you in illustrating the relationship between mental health and absenteeism in the workplace?” “In your truck and coach OYAP [Ontario Youth Apprenticeship Program] experience, you chose to investigate the various pathways to becoming an apprentice. You gathered information from mentors at your co-op placement, conducted interviews with other licensed journeypersons, and accessed various websites, print materials, and other resources. How are you going to organize the information in order to assess the pros and cons of each pathway?” “How might your previous co-op, employment, volunteer, or other experience help you in your investigation?” “How has your consideration of Indigenous perspectives and ways of knowing influenced your investigation?”

C2. Analysis and Communication

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 analyse and interpret information gathered through investigation of the chosen topic, issue, or process (e.g., *compare results of surveys and interviews that they have conducted to identify*

trends or preferences; determine whether common themes arise in the various sources consulted on the impact of social media in the workplace; use the information gathered to answer questions and test hypotheses about concrete recycling in the construction industry; compare the various pathways to apprenticeship in terms of criteria developed as they focused their investigation) and formulate conclusions (e.g., *make connections based on their interpretation of the evidence to arrive at answers to their research questions; confirm or reject hypotheses*)

Teacher prompts: “In your health care co-op experience, you’ve chosen to investigate how patients feel about their care experience. You’ve gathered information from journal articles and other media, and collected responses from clinical patient satisfaction surveys. How does the background research help you interpret the survey results?” “You have reviewed and analysed the information you gathered about pathways to becoming an apprentice, and you’ve weighed the pros and cons. Based on your analysis, which pathway do you think is the best ‘fit’ for you?” “Did your research about workplace accidents involving youth between the ages of 16 and 25 confirm anything that you already knew and understood about the types of accidents that occur? What did you learn that was new or surprising? How did your analysis of the statistics affect the conclusions you reached?” “What were your findings about the ways in which Indigenous communities are consulted in different countries about the development of energy resources?”

C2.2 communicate the results of their investigation, in a manner suited to purpose and audience (e.g., *an oral presentation about local tourist sites that have high appeal for teenagers; a game to engage elementary school students in learning about consumer awareness and advertising; a model to illustrate the benefits of a particular building technique; a display of drought-resistant native plants to help inform the design of a low-maintenance school-ground greening project; a poster promoting hand hygiene for infection prevention; a demonstration video of a cooking technique; an instruction manual [print or web-based] to support the creation of documents that comply with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act [AODA]; a blog on fashion trends; a graph that depicts the relationship between earnings and levels of education attained*)

Teacher prompts: “What form of communication did you choose, and why? How will you know if that form was effective for your purpose and audience? What would you do differently next time?” “When planning how to present the findings of your research, what did you do to

meet the needs or interests of your audience?" "In a parks and recreation co-op experience, what would be an effective way to communicate how to prevent insect bites during the summer season? What would the benefits be of creating a poster, offering a seminar, writing an information pamphlet, or creating an online resource?" "Why might a board game about the various pathways to apprenticeship appeal to a student in Grade 7 or 8?" "When might a drum song or a dance be an appropriate way to communicate the results of an investigation?"

C2.3 describe ways in which they will be able to apply the skills and knowledge gained or further developed through their investigation (*e.g., critical thinking and problem-solving skills; research and communication skills; knowledge about the organization or sector; knowledge about personal interests and strengths*) to their cooperative education experience and to other aspects of their lives, now and in the future (*e.g., at school, in the community, in postsecondary education or training, in the world of work, in everyday life*).

Teacher prompts: "How might you apply the skills and knowledge gained from your investigation into managing workplace stress to other areas of your life? Which techniques would you adopt to help you manage the stress of school deadlines and exams, combined with social pressures?" "How can you apply the skills and knowledge that you developed through your investigation of energy conservation strategies at home? At school? In your part-time job?" "You put together a checklist to support better safety practices related to your co-op experience. In what other areas of your life might you be able to apply the process of creating a checklist?" "You developed and maintained a digital portfolio and blog to document your research, analysis, and recommendations on adaptive clothing. What might you put in a digital portfolio to support an application to a postsecondary program? What do you need to do to maintain a positive online presence?" "You have researched how budgets are created for project management. How might you use this information to create a personal budget?"

D. BUILDING CAPACITY FOR LEARNING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Decision Making:** demonstrate an understanding of decision making and analyse how the decisions they make can impact their cooperative education experience and their future endeavours
- D2. Leadership:** demonstrate an understanding of effective leadership and how they can incorporate it into their lives

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Decision Making

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify and describe various decision-making strategies that might help them make informed decisions related to their cooperative education experience (e.g., *make sure to have sufficient and reliable information before making a decision; discuss pros and cons with a peer; seek the advice of a parent, a teacher, a counsellor, and/or an Elder – or in the case of an adult student, a partner; use a SWOT [strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats] analysis to help develop a business plan*)

Teacher prompts: “Reflection can be helpful when you are making decisions. You might reflect on the results of similar decisions in the past, on goals that you have set for yourself, or on the impact your decision might have on others. How can reflection help you make informed decisions about your cooperative education experience?” “What decision-making strategies do you use to keep yourself and others safe during your cooperative education experience?” “You are running late to your cooperative education placement, and you’re not sure what to do. You’d like to get some advice. How would you decide whom to consult?” “Do you consider impulse and/or intuition to be valid decision-making strategies? Why or why not? Under what circumstances might you act on impulse and/or intuition?” “You have been chosen to be on the school track team. Your co-op experience is scheduled for the afternoon, and the placement is an hour away from the school – meaning that you will be an hour late for practice. What strategies

would you use to make a decision in this situation?” “When is flipping a coin an appropriate decision-making strategy?”

- D1.2** identify, based on reflection, a range of factors that influence the decisions they make in connection with their cooperative education experience (e.g., *individual goals, abilities, interests, and needs; family expectations; individual or school- or family-related responsibilities; cultural or religious values; environmental, ethical, social justice, and/or financial considerations; the opinion of peers; scheduling conflicts*)

Teacher prompts: “There are some factors that affect your decisions that you can control and others that you cannot control. What are some examples of each?” “What factors influenced your decision in choosing your co-op placement?” “How will your co-op experience influence your course selections for next year?” “Apprentices may have to choose between working in a unionized or a non-unionized work environment. What factors would influence and support your choice?” “How might decisions that you make with respect to your cooperative education experience affect your overall personal well-being?” “Your placement supervisor asks you to attend a weekend conference that will provide you with a unique opportunity to network. What are some of the factors that might influence your decision to attend?” “A bike courier decided to forgo her route for the afternoon and instead went to a friend’s house. What might have been some of the factors that led to this decision?” “Your placement supervisor asks you to help determine new store hours. What factors should you consider when making your recommendations?”

D1.3 analyse how various decisions that they make in connection with their cooperative education experience could affect both that experience and future endeavours

Teacher prompts: “On a construction site, important decisions are made throughout the day regarding safety. Proper use of personal protective equipment (PPE) and following safety procedures are just two of the many aspects of safety that need to be considered. How might a seemingly minor decision regarding workplace safety affect another construction worker and others on the job site, now and in the future?” “What are some of the possible short- and long-term effects of posting an inappropriate picture on social media?” “You decide to show initiative during your co-op experience by offering to help your co-workers after you have completed your own work. What consequences might this decision have for you? How might it affect your co-workers? Your placement supervisor? What other consequences might flow from it, now and in the future?” “One day at your placement, you decide to leave an hour early without asking permission from your placement supervisor. Your co-op teacher arrives for a monitoring meeting and finds that you are not there. What would you do differently next time?” “Taking into consideration everything you have learned from your decisions throughout your cooperative education experience, what are your thoughts about pursuing a career in this sector?” “How can you take the advice of others into account while making choices that reflect who you are and who you want to become?” “Consider some of the decisions you have made during your co-op experience. Did any of them cause you to revise your goals?”

D2. Leadership

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 identify the attributes and skills needed to be an effective leader (e.g., **attributes:** initiative, integrity, honesty, empathy, tolerance, sensitivity to the needs of others, confidence, assertiveness, transparency; **skills:** the ability to look ahead, to transfer learning to new situations, to build positive relationships, to recognize others' contributions and individual differences, to recognize others' strengths and empower them to apply those strengths, to encourage the generation of ideas, to reflect on what might need to change in order to improve outcomes or to enhance learning, to listen to all perspectives in the group, to be confident when speaking, to communicate effectively in different contexts)

Teacher prompts: “Do you think leaders are born or made? Why?” “What is the difference between a leader and a manager? Consider this distinction in the context of a business office/ a health care clinic/ a youth organization.” “In what ways can all workers, or all members of an organization, reflect leadership qualities?” “How do leaders appeal to their followers? How do they motivate them?” “What does leadership look like in an online enterprise or community?” “Explain what is meant by a ‘quiet leader’. Give some examples of quiet leaders.” “How do expertise and/or experience contribute to a person’s abilities as a leader?”

D2.2 analyse the characteristics of various effective leaders (e.g., past, current, or emerging leaders; local, national, or international leaders; collective leadership) and the role of leaders in sectors related to the cooperative education experience

Teacher prompts: “You observed people in leadership roles during your cooperative education experience. What characteristics of effective leaders (attributes and skills) did you see in them? What actions did they take that demonstrated leadership?” “Why is it important for organizations/companies to have effective leaders?” “In your co-op experience, how did leaders anticipate and/or respond to environmental, social, political, and/or economic issues? How did their awareness of and response to such issues benefit the organization?” “How do effective leaders contribute to the success of employees? To the success of the organization or company?” “Depending on the situation, some characteristics of effective leaders come into play more than others. What sorts of situations arose during your experience that called for a leader’s assertiveness? In what circumstances did you witness a leader’s sensitivity and ability to empathize?” “Leadership can come from people working collaboratively – for instance, in industry associations, unions, band or community councils, and not-for-profit organizations or charities. Was collective leadership evident during your cooperative education experience? In what way?”

D2.3 identify ways in which they can make contributions as leaders in their cooperative education experience (e.g., initiating a “circle time” activity in the toddler room; creating a recycling program in the business office; organizing a lunch-and-learn session at the fitness centre; suggesting ways in which the dental clinic could be made more welcoming for younger clients; revising a “how to” video for present and future employees) and describe how they can use what they learned about leadership skills during their experience

in their daily lives, at school, and in the broader community (e.g., by approaching the student council or administration for support in addressing an issue; making sure to involve each group member in the decision-making process required to complete a group math assignment; mentoring a neighbour who is learning how to use social media; persevering in collaboratively resolving technical difficulties encountered during a robotics competition and encouraging teammates by offering positive feedback; being proactive in taking steps to prevent a conflict; offering to demonstrate skills learned during the cooperative education experience to peers)

Teacher prompts: “Your cooperative education experience involves you in developing a fundraising campaign to support a local charity. What are some of the attributes and skills you’ve gained through this experience that might assist you in your role as a member of the planning committee for the prom?” “Through your co-op experience at a local Indigenous organization, you explored the realities that Indigenous youth face. What leadership skills would you need to help engage diverse Indigenous and non-Indigenous young people in important conversations that could lead to social change?” “Reflecting on the attributes and skills you have developed during your cooperative education experience, which ones would you employ to gain the support of your community to ensure that your surroundings are safe, healthy, and well maintained?” “You notice that a student is being bullied. What have you learned in your cooperative education course that might help you support the student and take action to prevent further bullying?”